

Participant Report Form

Business Development Manager

AC-EXS® Interview Simulation - Internal



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Business Development Manager Participant Report Form

Name: Jason Coelho

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1. What was your plan for this Interview? How well did you follow it?

I wanted to meet Sam, set up a clear flow for the meeting and come away with next steps. It was my goal to find out Sam's side of the story, understand the underlying issues and get a commitment to next steps that project both the business and the employee. I need to make sure I fully understood what happened and find a solution. I felt that I was able to get a commitment from Sam and felt that the plan was relatively well executed.

2. What were the main points you wanted to get across? What is your understanding of what was finally agreed between the two of you?

I wanted to make sure that Sam understood that, I appreciate her initiative, that it was misguide. I needed to make sure she understood that as a company with a Board, her and I are both accountable to the company policies and procedure. Since she has been discouraged I wanted to reengage her while raining in the rogue behaviour and get a commitment to proper communication. She agreed to the next steps prior the meeting.

3. What was not covered and why? What unplanned areas were covered and why? How satisfied are you with the outcome from the meeting?

I would like to have spent more time in the beginning to build a little more rapport before diving into the meeting. I was nervous and stuck to a scripted start to get going but I felt I missed that in the beginning. The situation between Matt and Sam was more nuanced than expected and the role that Amanda had played in keeping Sam demotivated was also a factor in her feeling the need to work independantly.

4. What were the specific results of the interview? What actions were agreed?

1. Understand the whole situation from Sam's perspective 2. Understand all the communication and the information not in the brief 3. Get a read on Sam (body language, tone, etc) in order to know how best to approach her 4. Express gratitude for initiative 5. Express concern over behavior and communication style and why this is important for her and for the company 6. Get a commitment to specific steps (email Matt with me in copy, meeting with the 3 of us about the project to make a clear plan moving forward). These actions were agreed to but I didnt specify when and should have confirmed dates and times for commitments - I did say it but felt that it wasnt 100% clear. Ideally, I would have sent a recap email to her as well as the calendar invitation for the next meeting.

5. What is your assessment of Sam Gray? What are his/her strengths and weaknesses?

I feel Sam is driven, creative and takes initiative. She knows the business and is enthusiastic about growth and change. However her attitude and rogue behaviour is a concern and needs to be corrected. She did not have a good relationship with the previous manager. What I feel is missing is the structure or mechanism for her to submit ideas for the business. This is clearly a need for her and it's important that I can foster this while making sure the correct policies and procedures are followed. Priority is to get her on board with this and monitor the behaviour. With improvement, she can be given more creative projects to assist on - can scratch the itch while being supervised. Keeps her engaged and this is a reward for correcting her behaviour.

6. If you had to do this exercise again, would you do anything differently? Please explain.

Yes, it was an interesting thought experiment and allowed me to test my instincts. I would have liked to address the rapport in the beginning and get a formalized commitment from Sam in writing. I would have liked to be more articulate and perhaps firmer.

7. What, if anything, prevented you from doing better in this exercise?

This is a role that I am excited about. It is expected that I would experience some anxiety. Even though I felt that I prepped well and stayed as calm, I was still nervous and made a few mistakes.